Senior Citizen Request and Assistance Tracking System

Day 1 Project Proposal: Individual Mini Capstone

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1. Project Title

Senior Citizen Request and Assistance Tracking System

A web-based system for submitting, managing, and tracking assistance requests from senior citizens.

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2. Client

Senior Citizen Affairs Office / Local Community Organization

The office keeps the records of registered senior citizens in its community and handles their requests for support such as medical, financial, and social assistance.

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3. Problem Statement

The Senior Citizen Affairs Office currently receives and tracks assistance requests through paper forms, walk-ins, phone calls, or messages. This causes several problems:

- Senior citizen records are scattered and hard to search.
- Requests can be lost, duplicated, or forgotten.
- Staff cannot easily see which requests are pending, approved, or completed.
- Senior citizens have no way to check the status of their request without visiting or calling the office.
- Preparing summaries of how many requests were received or served takes too much manual work.

The office needs a simple, centralized web system where senior citizens can submit and monitor requests, and staff can manage records and process requests in one place.

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4. Objectives

General objective: Develop a web-based system that helps the Senior Citizen Affairs Office manage senior citizen records and assistance requests efficiently.

Specific objectives:

1. Provide secure login and registration using Laravel Sanctum token authentication.
2. Allow admin/staff to create, view, update, search, and delete senior citizen records.
3. Allow senior citizens to register, view their own profile, and update allowed information.
4. Allow senior citizens to submit assistance requests and view their status.
5. Allow admin/staff to review, approve, reject, and update the status of requests.
6. Provide a dashboard summarizing requests and registered seniors.
7. Provide search and filter tools for faster record lookup.
8. Build a tested REST API (Postman) with a React frontend, using Git and GitHub for version control.

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5. User Roles and Permissions

The system has two roles, stored in the `role` column of the `users` table (`admin` or `senior`). "Admin/Staff" is treated as a single `admin` role to keep the project simple.

Feature	Admin/Staff	Senior Citizen
Register account	No (seeded or created by admin)	Yes
Login / logout	Yes	Yes
View dashboard	Yes	No
Manage senior citizen records (CRUD)	Yes	No
View own profile	N/A	Yes
Update own profile (allowed fields only)	N/A	Yes
Manage assistance types	Yes	No (view only)

Feature	Admin/Staff	Senior Citizen
View all assistance requests	Yes	No
View own assistance requests	N/A	Yes
Submit assistance request	Yes (on behalf of a senior)	Yes
Edit own request	N/A	Only while status is Pending
Cancel own request	N/A	Only while status is Pending
Approve / reject requests	Yes	No
Update request status	Yes	No
Search / filter records	Yes	Own requests only
Delete records	Yes	No

Fields a senior citizen may update: contact number, address, barangay, emergency contact name and number, and password. Fields such as name, birthdate, and senior ID number can only be changed by admin/staff.

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6. Main Entities

users

Field	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
name	string	
email	string	unique
password	string	hashed
role	enum: admin, senior	default `senior`
timestamps		

senior_citizens

Field	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
user_id	FK to users	nullable, unique (walk-in seniors may have no account)
senior_id_number	string	unique
first_name	string	
last_name	string	
birthdate	date	
sex	enum: male, female	
address	string	
barangay	string	
contact_number	string	
emergency_contact_name	string	nullable
emergency_contact_number	string	nullable
timestamps		

assistance_types

Field	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
name	string	unique (e.g., Medical, Financial, Food)
description	text	nullable
timestamps		

request_statuses

Field	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
name	string	unique (Pending, Approved, Rejected, In Progress, Completed, Cancelled)
timestamps		

This is a small lookup table seeded once. It is not managed through the UI.

assistance_requests

Field	Type	Notes
id	bigint, PK	
senior_citizen_id	FK to senior_citizens	
assistance_type_id	FK to assistance_types	
request_status_id	FK to request_statuses	default Pending
title	string	
description	text	
date_needed	date	nullable
admin_remarks	text	nullable (reason for approval/rejection)
reviewed_by	FK to users	nullable
reviewed_at	timestamp	nullable
timestamps		

Relationships

- A **user** has one **senior citizen** profile (optional).
- A **senior citizen** has many **assistance requests**.
- An **assistance type** has many **assistance requests**.

- A **request status** has many **assistance requests**.
- An **assistance request** belongs to a senior citizen, an assistance type, and a status, and optionally to the admin who reviewed it.

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7. Planned Features

Authentication

- Register (seniors only), login, and logout with Laravel Sanctum tokens
- Role-based route protection in both the API (middleware) and React (protected routes)

Admin/Staff

- Dashboard with counts: total seniors, total requests, and requests per status
- Senior citizen management: add, view, edit, delete
- Assistance request management: view, approve, reject, update status, delete
- Assistance type management: add, edit, delete
- Search and filter: seniors by name, ID number, or barangay; requests by status, type, or keyword

Senior Citizen

- Register and login
- View and update own profile (allowed fields only)
- Submit a new assistance request
- View a list of own requests with their status
- View request details, including admin remarks
- Edit or cancel a request while it is still Pending

General

- Form validation (Laravel Form Requests and frontend checks)
- Pagination on list pages
- Basic loading and error messages
- Responsive layout

Not included (out of scope): email/SMS notifications, file uploads, reports/PDF export, audit logs, multiple staff permission levels, and payment features. These can be future enhancements.

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8. CRUD Resources

Resource	Create	Read	Update	Delete	Who
Senior Citizens	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Admin (seniors can read/update own profile only)
Assistance Requests	Yes	Yes	Yes (status, remarks; senior can edit while Pending)	Yes	Admin full access; seniors create and read their own
Assistance Types	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Admin (all authenticated users can read)
Users	Register only	Own account	Own password	No	Created through registration
Request Statuses	Seeded	Yes	No	No	Read-only lookup

The two main CRUD resources are **senior citizens** and **assistance requests**. Assistance types is a small supporting CRUD.

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9. Status Workflow

Statuses: Pending, Approved, Rejected, In Progress, Completed, Cancelled

```
Pending ⟶ Approved ⟶ In Progress ⟶ Completed
   |
   ├⟶ Rejected
   └⟶ Cancelled (by senior)
```

From	To	Done by
(new request)	Pending	System (default on submission)
Pending	Approved	Admin/Staff

From	To	Done by
Pending	Rejected	Admin/Staff (remarks required)
Pending	Cancelled	Senior citizen
Approved	In Progress	Admin/Staff
In Progress	Completed	Admin/Staff

Rules

- Rejected, Completed, and Cancelled are final statuses and cannot be changed.
- Seniors may edit or cancel a request only while it is Pending.
- Rejecting a request requires admin remarks.
- When admin approves or rejects, the system records `reviewed_by` and `reviewed_at`.
- The API rejects invalid transitions with a 422 response.

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10. Technology Stack

Layer	Technology
Frontend	React 18+ with Vite
Routing	React Router
HTTP client	Axios
Backend	Laravel 11 or 12 (REST API)
Language	PHP 8.2+
Authentication	Laravel Sanctum (token-based)
Database	MySQL / MariaDB
Version control	Git and GitHub
API testing	Postman

Project structure: two folders in one repository (or two repositories): `backend/` (Laravel API) and `frontend/` (React + Vite). The frontend stores the Sanctum token and sends it through an Axios interceptor on every request.

11. Proposed React Pages

Public pages

Route	Page
`/login`	Login
`/register`	Senior citizen registration

Senior citizen pages

Route	Page
`/my/profile`	View and edit own profile
`/my/requests`	List of own requests with status and filter
`/my/requests/new`	Submit new request form
`/my/requests/:id`	Request details (edit or cancel if Pending)

Admin/Staff pages

Route	Page
`/admin/dashboard`	Summary counts and recent requests
`/admin/seniors`	Senior citizens list with search and filter
`/admin/seniors/new`	Add senior citizen
`/admin/seniors/:id`	View senior details and their requests
`/admin/seniors/:id/edit`	Edit senior citizen
`/admin/requests`	All requests list with search and filters
`/admin/requests/:id`	Request details with approve, reject, and status update actions

Route	Page
`/admin/assistance-types`	Manage assistance types

Other

Route	Page
`*`	Not Found

Shared components

Navbar/Sidebar (role-based links), ProtectedRoute (checks login and role), StatusBadge, SearchBar, Pagination, ConfirmDialog, and reusable form inputs.

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12. Proposed Laravel API Endpoints

All routes are prefixed with `/api`. Routes marked **auth** require `auth:sanctum`. Routes marked **admin** also require a `role:admin` middleware.

Authentication

Method	Endpoint	Access	Description
POST	`/register`	Public	Register senior (creates user and senior profile)
POST	`/login`	Public	Login and return token
POST	`/logout`	Auth	Revoke current token
GET	`/user`	Auth	Get logged-in user

Senior citizen (own data)

Method	Endpoint	Access	Description
GET	`/my-profile`	Auth (senior)	View own profile

Method	Endpoint	Access	Description
PUT	`/my-profile`	Auth (senior)	Update allowed profile fields
GET	`/my-requests`	Auth (senior)	List own requests (supports `status` and `search` filters)
POST	`/my-requests`	Auth (senior)	Submit a new request
GET	`/my-requests/{id}`	Auth (senior)	View own request details
PUT	`/my-requests/{id}`	Auth (senior)	Edit own request (Pending only)
PATCH	`/my-requests/{id}/cancel`	Auth (senior)	Cancel own request (Pending only)

Lookups

Method	Endpoint	Access	Description
GET	`/assistance-types`	Auth	List assistance types
GET	`/request-statuses`	Auth	List statuses

Admin: senior citizens

Method	Endpoint	Description
GET	`/admin/senior-citizens`	List with search (`search` , `barangay`) and pagination
POST	`/admin/senior-citizens`	Create senior record
GET	`/admin/senior-citizens/{id}`	View senior record
PUT	`/admin/senior-citizens/{id}`	Update senior record

Method	Endpoint	Description
DELETE	`/admin/senior-citizens/{id}`	Delete senior record

Admin: assistance requests

Method	Endpoint	Description
GET	`/admin/assistance-requests`	List with filters (`status` , `assistance_type_id` , `search`) and pagination
POST	`/admin/assistance-requests`	Create request on behalf of a senior
GET	`/admin/assistance-requests/{id}`	View request details
PUT	`/admin/assistance-requests/{id}`	Update request details
PATCH	`/admin/assistance-requests/{id}/approve`	Approve (with optional remarks)
PATCH	`/admin/assistance-requests/{id}/reject`	Reject (remarks required)
PATCH	`/admin/assistance-requests/{id}/status`	Update status (In Progress, Completed)
DELETE	`/admin/assistance-requests/{id}`	Delete request

Admin: assistance types

Method	Endpoint	Description
POST	`/admin/assistance-types`	Create type
PUT	`/admin/assistance-types/{id}`	Update type
DELETE	`/admin/assistance-types/{id}`	Delete type (blocked if it is used by requests)

Admin: dashboard

Method	Endpoint	Description
GET	`/admin/dashboard`	Totals: seniors, requests, requests per status, and recent requests

Response conventions

- JSON responses with consistent status codes: 200, 201, 401, 403, 404, 422
- Validation through Form Request classes
- API Resources for formatting output
- Pagination for list endpoints

Suggested Development Plan (Brief)

1. **Day 1:** Proposal, GitHub repository, Laravel and Vite setup
2. **Backend:** migrations, models, seeders, Sanctum auth, role middleware, controllers, Postman tests
3. **Frontend:** auth pages, Axios setup, protected routes, senior pages, admin pages, dashboard
4. **Final days:** validation polish, bug fixes, README, and demo preparation